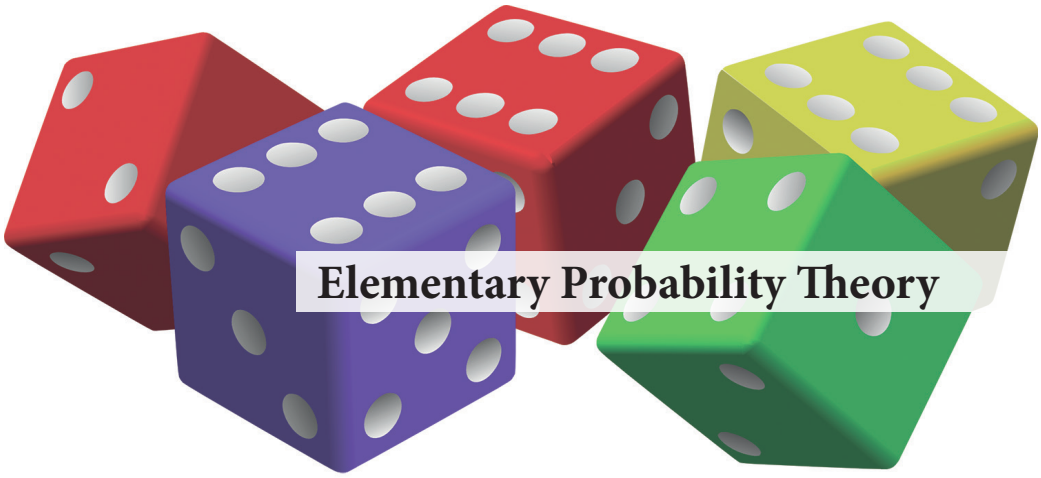
Chapter

8



Elementary Probability Theory



Blaise Pascal

(19 June, 1623 - 19 August, 1662)

Blaise Pascal was a French mathematician, who laid the foundation for the modern theory of probabilities. He was a child prodigy.

In 1642, while still a teenager, he started some pioneering work on calculating machines. After three years of effort, he built 20 finished machines (called Pascal's calculators) over the following 10 years, establishing him as one of the first two inventors of the mechanical calculator.

Pascal was an important mathematician, he wrote a significant treatise on the subject geometry and projective geometry at the age of 16, and later corresponded with Pierre de Fermat on probability theory, strongly influencing the development of modern economics and social science. Pascal's results caused many disputes before being accepted.

'The scientific imagination always restrains itself within the limits of probability'.

- Thomas Huxley

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Learning Objectives

- Knows about random experiments, trials, outcomes, events, sample space
- Understands the theorems on probability and applies in problems.
- Understands Independent events and multiplication theorem on probability.
- Explains conditional probability.
- Knows the application of Bayes' Theorem.